

The Contemporary World - Module 2 Reviewer

Structures of Globalization

Overview

Globalization runs through structures: markets, states and institutions, cultural networks, and technology. This module maps each and shows how they overlap.

Learning Outcomes

- Describe the global economy, global politics, and global culture as structures.
- Explain how technology connects these structures.
- Identify who benefits and who is left behind by each structure.

The Global Economy

The global economy is a network of trade, finance, and production that crosses borders. Multinational corporations split production across countries, forming global value chains in which design, manufacturing, and assembly happen in different places.

- Global value chains
- Multinational and transnational corporations
- Trade and financial flows

Global Politics

Politics also operates beyond the nation. States still matter, but decisions are shaped by international organizations, treaties, and non-state actors such as NGOs and advocacy networks.

- States plus international organizations
- Global agreements on trade, climate, and human rights
- Power is unevenly distributed

Global Culture

Scholars debate three outcomes: homogenization (cultures becoming alike), polarization (cultures clashing), and hybridization or "glocalization" (global forms adapted locally). Filipino adaptations of global fast food and K-pop fandoms are common examples of the third.

- Homogenization, polarization, hybridization
- Glocalization: global forms with local flavor
- Media and identity

Global Technology

Digital networks make the other structures possible. The internet, mobile phones, and cloud platforms let money, information, and work move instantly, but they also create a digital divide between

connected and unconnected communities.

- Internet as infrastructure of globalization
- Remote work and outsourcing (BPO in the Philippines)
- The digital divide

Review Questions

1. Explain: The Global Economy.
2. Explain: Global Politics.
3. Explain: Global Culture.
4. Explain: Global Technology.